

HC Services — People Code

Section 4: Remote Work & Flexible Working Policy

Section 4.0: Document Control

Document Reference: HC-PC-004

Version: 2.0

Effective Date: 1 July 2026

Status: current

Owner: People & Culture Division

Version	Effective from	Superseded on	What changed
2.0	1 July 2026	—	Internet allowance raised to AED 200 and the qualifying threshold lowered to more than 6 remote days per month.
1.5	1 March 2025	30 June 2026	Allowance AED 150 at more than 8 remote days per month. Retained in full at \$4.9.

Section 4.1: Policy Scope

This policy applies to employees who have **completed probation** (HC-PC-003 §3.3.2) and whose role is classified as remote-compatible under §4.2.2. Employees serving probation are not eligible, save under the exception at §4.5.2.

Section 4.2: Eligibility Criteria

4.2.1 Performance Requirement

An employee is eligible where they have been confirmed in post and hold a current performance rating of **3 or above** on the five-point scale at HC-PC-007 §7.8. An employee on a formal performance or disciplinary process is not eligible for the duration of that process.

4.2.2 Role Classification

Role classes are defined at HC-PC-007 §7.7. Remote allocation follows the class, not the grade:

Role class	Examples	Maximum remote days per week
Class A — location independent	Consulting, analysis, software, design	2 days
Class B — partially location dependent	Client delivery, People & Culture, Finance	1 day
Class C — location dependent	Facilities management, reception, IT hardware support, security	0 days

A Class C role is not remote-compatible. Refusal on this ground is a matter of role classification, not of performance or conduct, and may be reviewed under §4.5.2.

Section 4.3: Remote Work Arrangements

4.3.1 Standard Pattern

Eligible employees work a **minimum of 3 days per week** in the office and a **maximum of 2 days per week** remotely, subject to the class limit at §4.2.2.

4.3.2 Additional In-Office Requirements

A line manager may require additional in-office attendance for team meetings, client engagements, or project milestones, giving **24 hours'** notice.

4.3.3 Working Abroad

Working remotely from outside the UAE requires **4 weeks'** advance approval from the line manager, People & Culture, and Legal, and is limited to **15 working days** per leave year. Approval is refused where the destination creates a tax or permanent-establishment risk. Employees relocating rather than travelling should refer to HC-PC-011, which is listed as unpublished at HC-PC-007 §7.10.

Section 4.4: Employee Obligations During Remote Work

4.4.1 Availability

Employees must be contactable and available during the core hours of **09:00 to 15:00 Gulf Standard Time**, and must record remote days in Omni in advance.

4.4.2 Workspace and Security

Employees must work from a private, secure location. Company data may not be accessed over public or unsecured networks. Confidential material may not be printed at home. A security breach while working remotely is dealt with under HC-PC-006 §6.5.

Section 4.5: Approval Process

4.5.1 Standard Application

Applications are made on **Form HR-R-01** (HC-PC-007 §7.9) and approved by the line manager within **5 working days**. An approved arrangement is reviewed every **90 days**.

4.5.2 Exceptions

People & Culture may grant an exception to the probation requirement at §4.1, or to the role classification at §4.2.2, on medical or caring grounds supported by documentation. An exception is time-limited and reviewed at each 90-day cycle.

Section 4.6: Equipment & IT Support

4.6.1 Equipment

The Company provides a laptop and, on request, a monitor and keyboard for home use. Equipment remains Company property and is returned on separation.

4.6.2 Internet Allowance

An employee working **more than 6 remote days in a calendar month** may claim a monthly internet allowance of **AED 200**. The claim is submitted with a receipt through the expense process at HC-PC-005 §5.7.1 and is not subject to the prior-authorisation threshold at HC-PC-005 §5.2.1.

Section 4.7: Policy Violations

Persistent failure to attend the office on the agreed pattern, or misrepresentation of remote working location, may result in withdrawal of the arrangement and disciplinary action under HC-PC-006 §6.5.

Section 4.9: Appendix A — Superseded Provisions (Version 1.5)

SUPERSEDED — DO NOT APPLY TO CLAIMS FOR MONTHS BEGINNING ON OR AFTER 1 JULY 2026. The provision below was in force from 1 March 2025 to 30 June 2026 under Version 1.5. The provision currently in force is §4.6.2.

A.1 Internet Allowance (Version 1.5, in force 1 March 2025 – 30 June 2026)

Employees working more than **8 remote days per month** may claim a monthly internet allowance of **AED 150**, subject to submission of receipts.

For queries about this policy, contact People & Culture at people@hcservices.ae or raise a query via the HCS Concierge.